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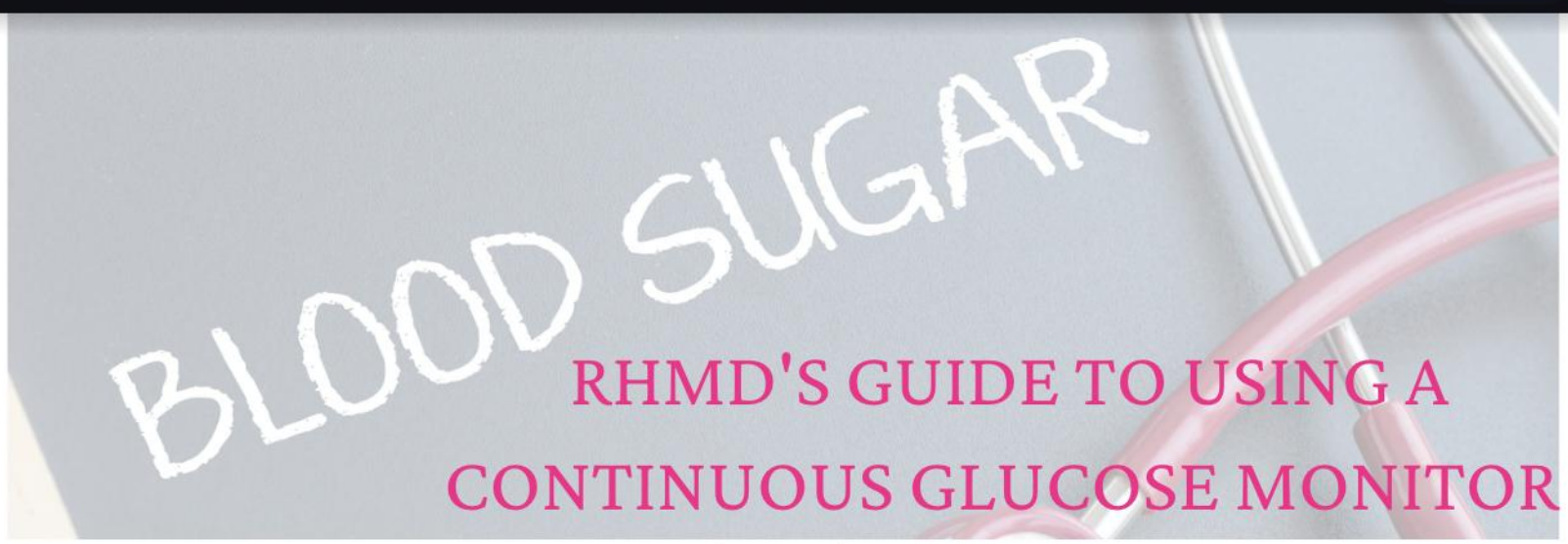

RHMD'S GUIDE TO USING A CONTINUOUS GLUCOSE MONITOR

A Continuous Glucose Monitor (CGM) is a device used to understand your glucose response to different foods, types of exercise, or to gain insights into your health. As cancer is a metabolic disease, and glucose levels are a significant indicator of metabolic health, it is important to know your glucose levels so that you know if and when they need optimizing.

1. **Understand How Your CGMs Works:** Learn about the basic functioning of your CGM. These devices use a tiny sensor inserted under the skin to measure glucose levels in the interstitial fluid. The data is transmitted to a receiver or a smartphone app, allowing you to monitor glucose trends continuously.
2. **Insertion and Setup:** Follow the manufacturer's instructions to properly insert the sensor. Usually, the process involves cleaning the insertion site, attaching the sensor, and pairing it with the receiver or app.
3. **Interpreting the Data:** Non-diabetic users should interpret CGM data differently from diabetic individuals. You should focus on patterns and trends rather than individual readings. Pay attention to how your glucose levels respond to meals, exercise, stress, and other lifestyle factors. Specific optimal levels are listed below.
4. **Recognize Normal Glucose Levels:** Know the optimal range for blood glucose levels, which typically falls between 70-120 mg/dL (3.9-7.8 mmol/L) for non-diabetic individuals. However, glucose levels can vary based on individual factors. See the guide below.

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5. **Stay Hydrated:** Drinking plenty of water can help maintain stable glucose levels and reduce the chances of inaccurate readings caused by dehydration.
6. **Record Your Activities and Food Intake:** Keep a diary of your meals, exercise routines, stress levels, and any medications or supplements taken. This information will help you correlate changes in glucose levels with specific factors.
7. **Watch for Hypoglycemia Symptoms:** While non-diabetic individuals are at a lower risk of hypoglycemia (low blood sugar), it's still essential to be aware of the symptoms, such as dizziness, confusion, shakiness, and irritability. This can happen if your diet includes too much sugar or processed foods or if you are on glucose lowering supplements like berberine, chromium, alpha-lipoic acid, gymnema, or metformin.
8. **Maintain the Device Properly:** Ensure you follow the device's maintenance guidelines. Replace the sensor as recommended, keep the insertion site clean, and charge the receiver if applicable.
9. **Discontinue Use If Necessary:** If you experience any adverse reactions or discomfort while using the CGM, discontinue use and consult your healthcare professional.
10. **Share the information with your doctor:** Sharing the information can help your doctor/provider create the plan that ensures your metabolic health.

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HERE ARE THE GENERAL OPTIMAL BLOOD GLUCOSE GUIDELINES FOR NON-DIABETIC INDIVIDUALS

Fasting Glucose Levels:

- Optimal Range: 70-90 mg/dL (3.9-5.4 mmol/L)
- Fasting glucose refers to the blood glucose level after at least 8 hours of fasting, usually measured in the morning before eating breakfast.

Pre-Prandial (Before Meals) Glucose Levels:

- Optimal Range: 70-90 mg/dL (3.9-5.4 mmol/L)
- Pre-prandial levels indicate blood glucose levels before eating a meal or snack.

Post-Prandial (After Meals) Glucose Levels:

- Optimal Range: Less than 120 mg/dL (7.6 mmol/L) is an optimal post prandial glucose.
- Post-prandial levels indicate blood glucose levels about 1-2 hours after starting a meal.

Exercise and Glucose Levels:

- The impact of exercise on blood glucose levels can vary among individuals and the type/intensity of exercise performed.
- Moderate-intensity aerobic exercise can help improve insulin sensitivity and lower blood glucose levels.
- During exercise, blood glucose levels may temporarily increase due to the release of glucose from the liver as a source of energy. However, with continued exercise, glucose levels typically decrease. Pay attention to what happens with your blood glucose according to the type and duration of exercise you are doing.

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Stress and Glucose levels

- Glucose can increase during times of stress (this results from an elevation in cortisol levels). You can use your glucose monitor to determine the effect of stress on your system.

Sleep Disruption and Glucose Levels

- Many people have sleep disruption due to fluctuating glucose levels. This is made worse by carbohydrate rich meals consumed close to bedtime. If you are waking at night with sweats or hot flashes, check your blood sugar. High or low blood sugar could be contributing to your sleep disruption.

It's important to note that individual variations exist, and some people may have slightly higher or lower blood glucose levels within a healthy range. Also, blood glucose levels can be affected by factors like age, diet, activity level, and overall health. It is important to note that fasting blood sugar above 90mg/dL or post-prandial levels above 140mg/dL is a pre-diabetic condition and immediate measures should be taken to optimize blood glucose and restore metabolic health.